SECOND HAND

for violoncello and piano

CERA WANG

2026

Full score

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Preface

Second Hand is a single-movement work for violoncello and piano, composed in 2026. It is the composer's first original work. This score is the composer's own fair copy and constitutes the definitive text; no earlier version is authorised.

Acknowledgements

Thank you to Dr.Sunabacka for leading the MUSIC 376 course in which this score is written for.

First performance

Oct. 7, CGR 1302, Waterloo

Karen Sunabacka, violoncello

Cera Wang, piano

Duration

c. 1′30″

The written accelerando between bars 9 and 18 is at the performers' discretion within the metronome marks given; timings will vary slightly between performances.

Programme note
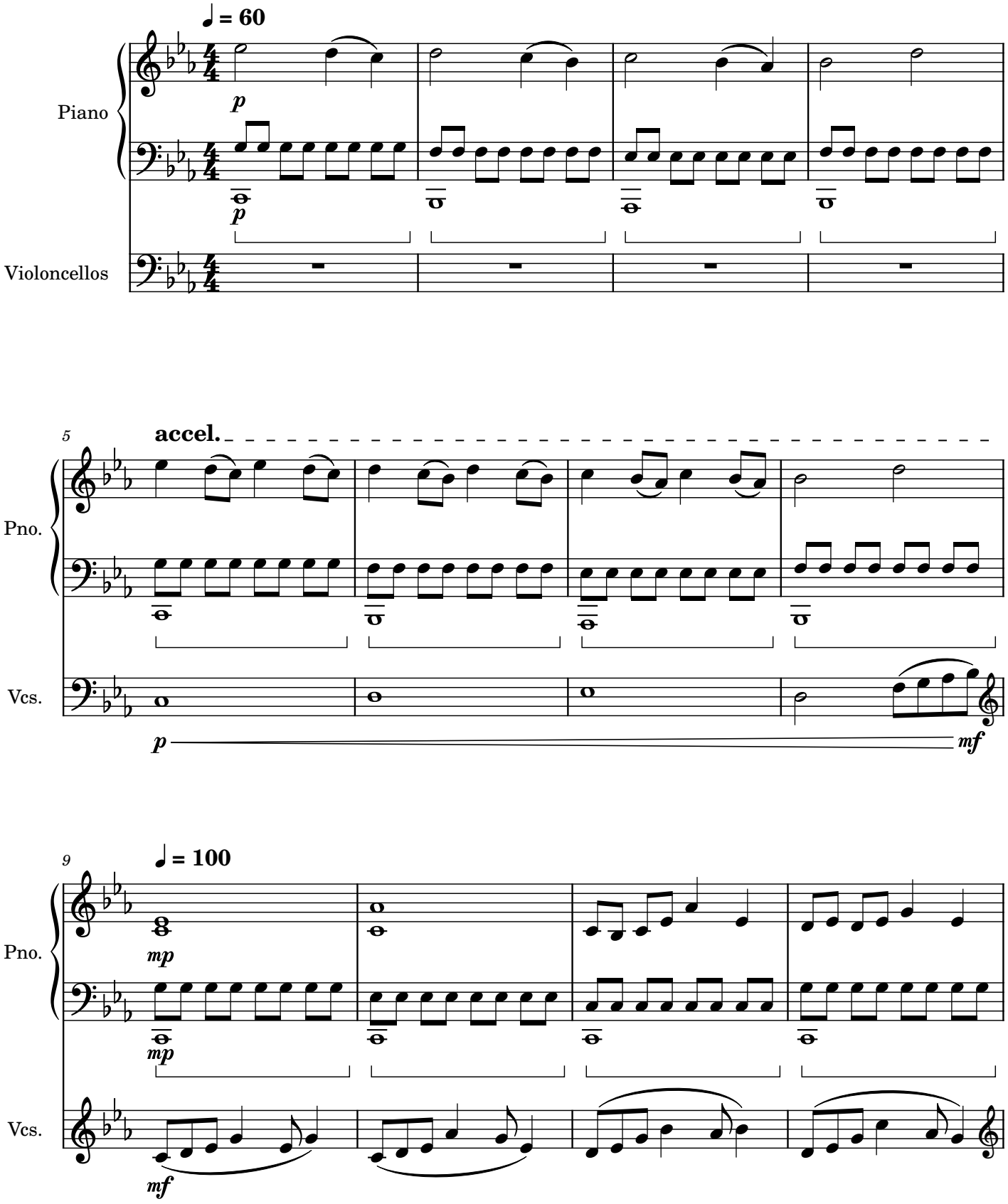
The title means two things at once. A second hand is the part of a clock that moves while you watch it, and to come second is to lose.

The piece is built on a repeated quaver figure in the piano's left hand, set at ♩ = 60 so that each beat lasts exactly one second. It does not stop from the first bar to the last.
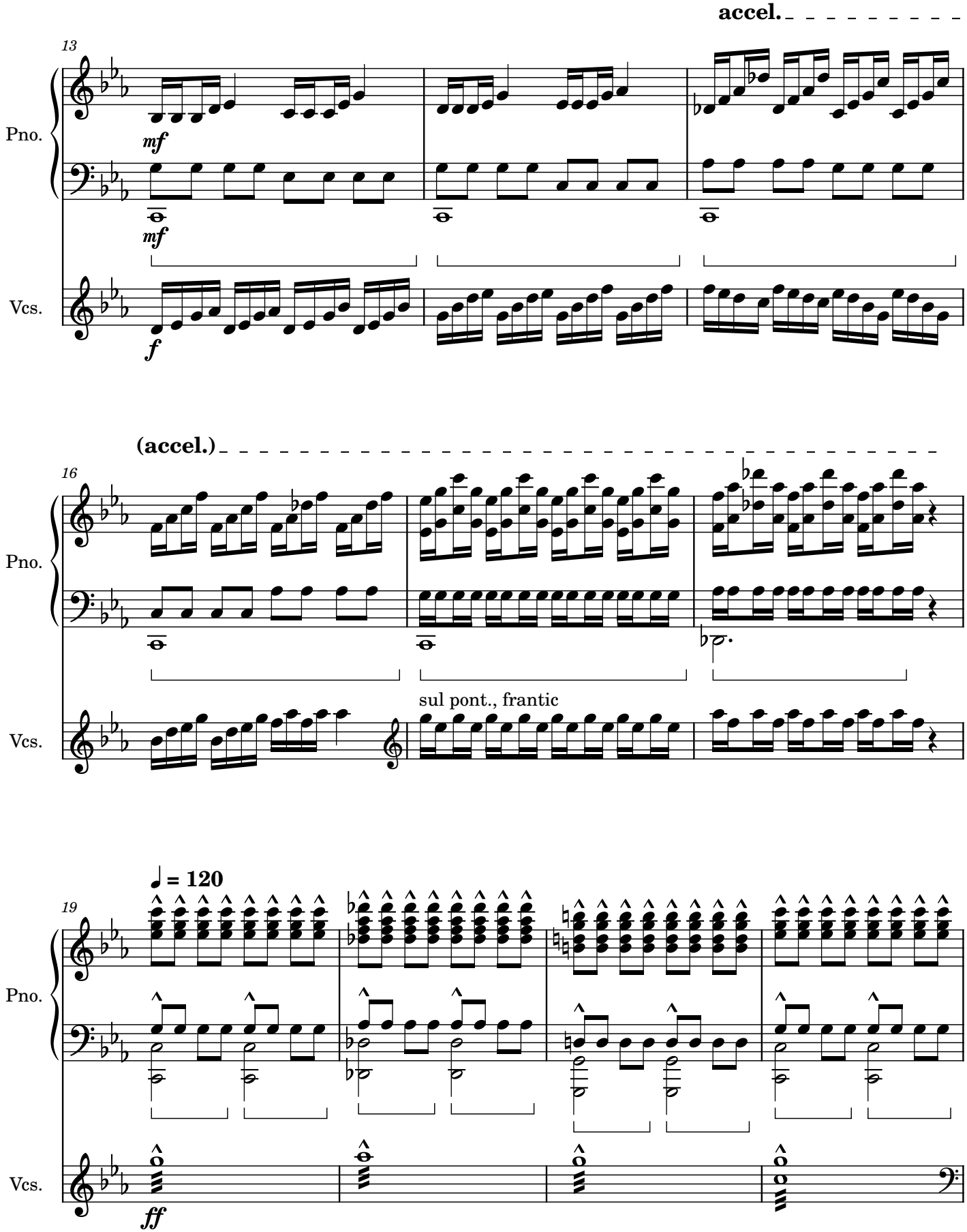
Afterwards the opening returns, at precisely the tempo it began. Nothing has been gained. The violoncello stops playing one bar before the piano does, and the clock finishes the piece alone.
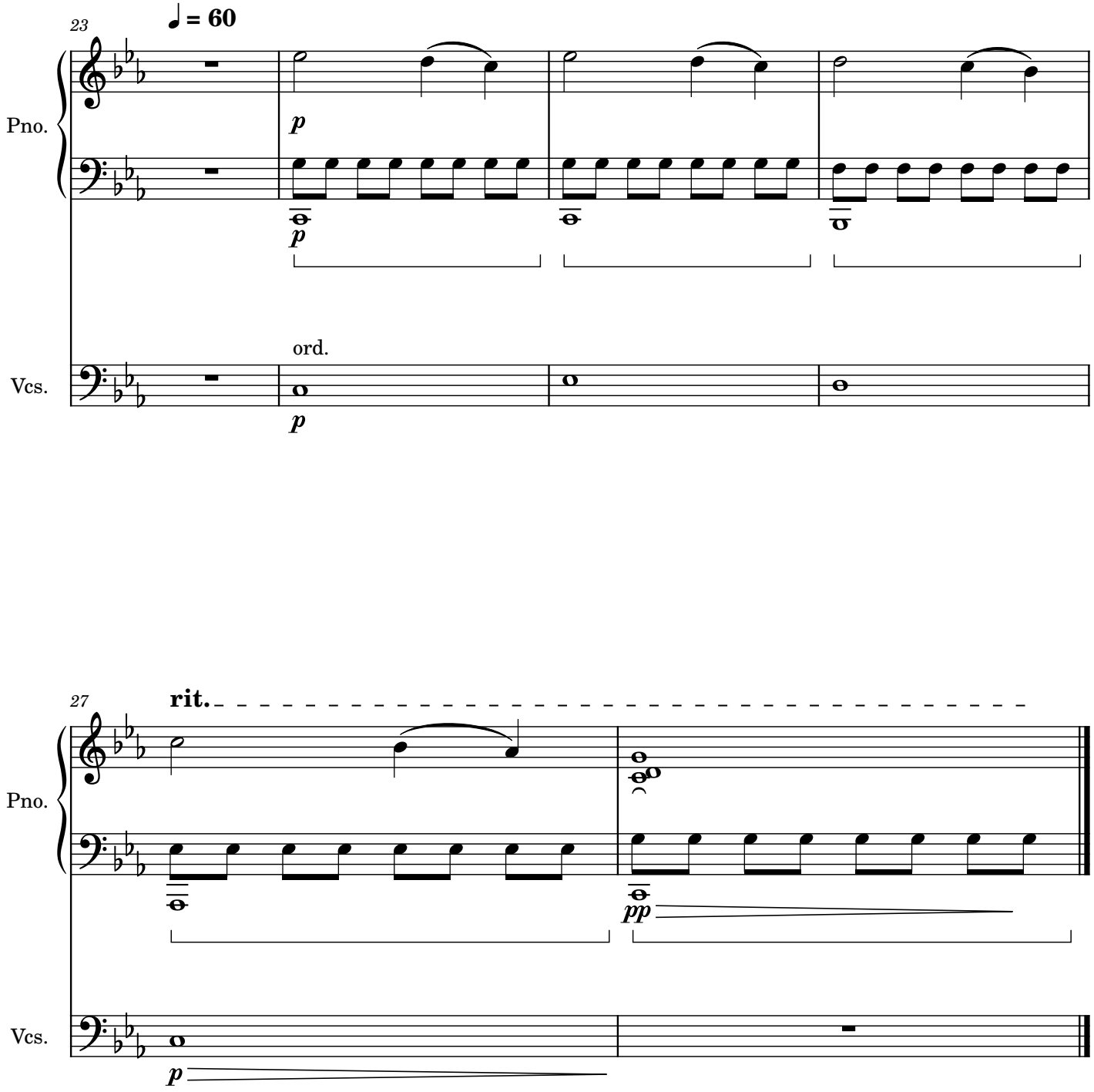
Second Hand

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accel.
13
Pno.
mf
mf
Vcs.
f
(accel.)
16
Pno.
sul pont., frantic
Vcs.
♩ = 120
19
Pno.
Vcs.
ff


23
♩ = 60
Pno.
p
p
Vcs.
ord.
p
27
rit.
Pno.
pp
Vcs.
p